

General Knowledge

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STUDY NOTES

International Awards II



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Templeton Prize

- The Templeton Prize is an annual award given by the Templeton Foundation, recognizing individuals who have made exceptional contributions to affirming life's spiritual dimension, through insights, discoveries, or work in areas such as science, religion, philosophy, or other fields that explore the relationship between science and spirituality.
- The prize was established in 1972 by Sir John Templeton, a financier and philanthropist, and it has since become one of the most prestigious awards in the world, often referred to as "the Nobel Prize for spirituality." The prize comes with a substantial monetary award, which can be as high as USD 2.1 million, depending on the year

Notable Winners:

- *Mother Teresa* (1973) – for her humanitarian work and dedication to helping the poor and sick.
- *Desmond Tutu* (2013) – for his efforts in combating apartheid in South Africa and his work in reconciliation.
- Alvin Plantinga (2017) for his work in philosophy of religion.
- Francis Collins (2007), a physician-geneticist known for his work on the Human Genome Project, for his writings and advocacy for the compatibility of science and faith.

Templeton Prize laureates from 2020 to 2024:

Year	Laureate	Field	Contribution
2024	Dr. Pumla Gobodo-Madi kizela	Psychology	Recognized for her profound insights into trauma and forgiveness in post-apartheid South Africa, developing a globally recognized model for social healing termed "the reparative quest."

2023	Edna Adan Ismail	Nursing and Midwifery	Honored for her extensive work in healthcare advocacy, particularly in improving maternal and infant health in Somaliland, and for her efforts in combating female genital mutilation.
2022	Dr. Frank Wilczek	Theoretical Physics	Awarded for his contributions to fundamental physics, including the discovery of asymptotic freedom and the development of quantum chromodynamics, as well as his philosophical reflections on the nature of reality.
2021	Dr. Jane Goodall	Ethology	Celebrated for her pioneering research on chimpanzee behaviour, which has deepened our understanding of primate intelligence and social structures, and for her lifelong commitment to conservation and animal welfare.
2020	Dr. Francis Collins	Genetics	Recognized for leading the Human Genome Project to its successful completion and advocating for the integration of faith and reason, notably through his book "The Language of God," which argues for the harmony between science and religious belief.

Ramon Magsaysay Award

- The Ramon Magsaysay Award is one of the most prestigious awards in Asia, often referred to as the "Asian Nobel Prize."
- It was established in 1957 by the Philippines government in honour of Ramon Magsaysay, the seventh president of the Philippines, who was known for his integrity, leadership, and dedication to public service.
- The award aims to recognize individuals and organizations across Asia who have made significant contributions in various fields, including public service, community leadership, journalism, government service, social work, and environmental advocacy.
- The recipients are often celebrated for their work towards improving the lives of people in their communities, and the award is meant to inspire others to follow in their footsteps.

- The Magsaysay Award is given annually and includes a medal, a certificate, and a cash prize. Past winners include prominent figures like Jose W. Diokno, Ralph Waldo Emerson, and Dr. Fe del Mundo.
- **The main categories for the award include:**



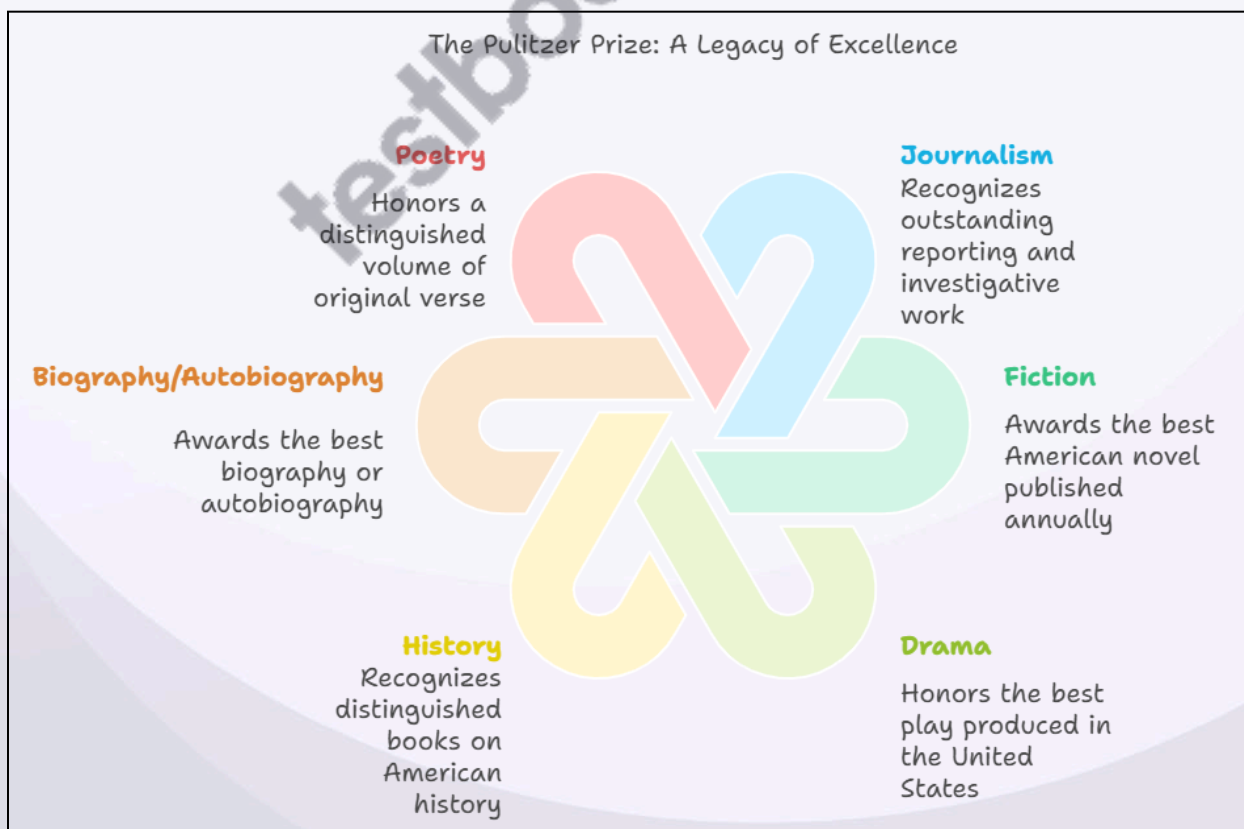
Ramon Magsaysay Award 2024 winners:

Year	Recipient	Country	Contribution
2024	Miyazaki Hayao	Japan	Renowned filmmaker and co-founder of Studio Ghibli, recognized for his use of animation to explore and elevate the human condition through storytelling.

2024	Farwiza Farhan	Indonesia	Environmentalism advocating for the protection of Indonesia's rainforests and social justice, co-founder of the HAKA Foundation.
2024	Karma Phuntsho	Bhutan	Scholar and cultural preservationist, honored for documenting and digitizing Bhutan's cultural heritage to align with modern aspirations.
2024	Dr. Nguyen Thi Ngoc Phuong	Vietnam	Physician and advocate for Agent Orange victims, dedicated to public health and seeking justice for those affected by the Vietnam War.
2024	Rural Doctors Movement	Thailand	Collective healthcare professionals revolutionizing rural healthcare in Thailand since the 1970s, ensuring healthcare access for the rural poor.

Pulitzer Prize

- The Pulitzer Prize is one of the most prestigious awards in the United States, recognizing excellence in journalism, literature, and musical composition.



- It was established in 1917 by the will of Joseph Pulitzer, a Hungarian-American newspaper publisher, and is administered by Columbia University.
- The Pulitzer Prize also includes a cash award, typically \$15,000 for most categories, along with a certificate. Winners in the public service category of journalism receive a gold medal.
- The Pulitzer Prizes are awarded by an advisory board and juries, and the winners are announced each year in April.

Category	2023 Winner	2022 Winner	2021 Winner
Journalism	The New York Times (COVID-19 pandemic coverage)	The Washington Post (January 6 Capitol riot reporting)	The New York Times (Trump administration COVID-19 report)
Fiction	Trust by Hernan Diaz	The Night Watchman by Louise Erdrich	The Night Circus by Erin Morgenstern
Drama	Fat Ham by James Ijames	Sweat by Lynn Nottage	A Strange Loop by Michael R. Jackson
History	The American Experiment by David M. Kennedy	The Dead Are Arising by Les Payne and Tamara Payne	The Color of Law by Richard Rothstein
Biography	The Man Who Knew by George Packer	The Dead Are Arising by Les Payne and Tamara Payne	The Yellow House by Sarah M. Broom
Poetry	The Tradition by Jericho Brown	Postcolonial Love Poem	The Hurting Kind by Ada Limón

		by Natalie Diaz	
Music	The Central Park Five by Anthony Davis	The (R)evolution of Steve Jobs by Mason Bates	The (R)evolution of Steve Jobs by Mason Bates

Ramanujan Prize for Young Mathematicians

The **Ramanujan Prize for Young Mathematicians** is awarded annually to honour exceptional contributions in fields influenced by the renowned Indian mathematician Srinivasa Ramanujan. Two prominent awards are associated with this recognition:

- **SASTRA Ramanujan Prize:** Established in 2005 by the Shanmugha Arts, Science, Technology & Research Academy (SASTRA) in Tamil Nadu, India, this prize is awarded to mathematicians worldwide who are 32 years old or younger, reflecting the age at which Ramanujan passed away. The award includes a cash prize of \$10,000.
- **DST-ICTP-IMU Ramanujan Prize:** Instituted in 2005 by the International Centre for Theoretical Physics (ICTP) in collaboration with the Department of Science and Technology (DST) of the Government of India and the International Mathematical Union (IMU), this prize honors young mathematicians from developing countries under the age of 45. The award carries a cash prize of \$15,000.

Year	Prize	Recipient	Affiliation	Contribution
2024	SASTRA Ramanujan Prize	Alexander Dunn	Georgia Institute of Technology, USA	Recognized for significant breakthroughs in the study of modular forms, half-integral weight forms, metaplectic forms, and their relationships with prime numbers and integer partitions.

2024	DST-ICTP-IM U Ramanujan Prize	Ruochuan Liu	Peking University, China	Honoured for fundamental contributions to p-adic Hodge theory, especially his foundational study of relative p-adic Hodge theory and his remarkable work on rigidity and the Riemann-Hilbert correspondence for p-adic local systems.
2023	SASTRA Ramanujan Prize	Ruixiang Zhang	University of California, Berkeley, USA	Awarded for outstanding contributions in analytic number theory and related areas.

FIFA Ballon d'Or

- The FIFA Ballon d'Or is one of the most prestigious awards in football, presented annually to the world's best male player.
- Originally established as the Ballon d'Or by France Football in 1956, it merged with FIFA's World Player of the Year award from 2010 to 2015 to form the FIFA Ballon d'Or.
- This combined award considered votes from coaches, team captains, and journalists worldwide.
- However, in 2016, FIFA and France Football separated again, reviving the Ballon d'Or as a France Football award and FIFA's "The Best" as FIFA's independent accolade.

Notable Winners:

- *Lionel Messi* (7-time winner) – for his exceptional skills and records with Barcelona and Argentina.
- *Cristiano Ronaldo* (5-time winner) – for his impact on football, notably with Real Madrid and Portugal.
- The Ballon d'Or remains a celebrated measure of individual achievement in the sport.

Recent Winners

Year	Men's Ballon d'Or Winner	Club(s) During Award Period	Women's Ballon d'Or Winner	Club(s) During Award Period
2021	Lionel Messi	Paris Saint-Germain	Alexia Putellas	Barcelona
2022	Karim Benzema	Real Madrid	Alexia Putellas	Barcelona
2023	Lionel Messi	Inter Miami	Aitana Bonmati	Barcelona
2024	Rodri	Manchester City	Aitana Bonmati	Barcelona

The Right Livelihood Award

- The Right Livelihood Award, often referred to as the "Alternative Nobel Prize," was established in 1980 by Jakob von Uexkull, a Swedish-German philanthropist and activist.
- It is awarded annually to honour and support individuals and organizations that offer practical solutions to global issues, particularly in areas where traditional Nobel Prizes are less focused.
- The award typically celebrates efforts in human rights, environmental protection, sustainable development, health, education, peace, and social justice. Each year, a selection committee reviews nominees from around the world, emphasizing actions that promote social transformation, resilience, and grassroots activism.
- **Some notable past recipients include:**
 - Greta Thunberg (2019) for her climate activism.
 - The White Helmets (2016), a volunteer civil defence group in Syria.
 - Edward Snowden (2014), for his role in exposing government surveillance.

Goldman Environmental Prize

- The Goldman Environmental Prize is one of the most prestigious awards in the field of environmental activism, often referred to as the "Green Nobel."
- It was established in 1989 by philanthropists Richard and Rhoda Goldman to recognize individuals for sustained and significant efforts to protect and enhance the natural environment.

Notable Winners:

- Chico Mendes (1990): A Brazilian rubber tapper and environmentalist, he worked to prevent deforestation in the Amazon and protect the rights of indigenous communities.
- Greta Thunberg (2019): Known for her climate activism and leading global school strikes, Greta raised awareness on climate change on an international scale.
- Leydy Pech (2020): A Mayan beekeeper from Mexico, she fought against genetically modified soy plantations to protect the Yucatán Peninsula's biodiversity.

Winners of 2024

Year	Region	Recipient(s)	Country	Contribution
2024	Africa	Nonhle Mbuthuma and Sinegugu Zukulu	South Africa	Indigenous activists who halted destructive seismic testing for oil and gas off South Africa's Eastern Cape, protecting the marine environment and asserting community rights.
	Asia	Alok Shukla	India	Led a community campaign that saved 445,000 acres of biodiversity-rich forests in Chhattisgarh from 21 planned coal mines, preserving one of India's largest intact forest areas.
	Europe	Teresa Vicente	Spain	Spearheaded a grassroots campaign resulting in a 2022 law granting legal rights to the Mar Menor, Europe's largest saltwater lagoon, to protect it from ecological collapse.
	Islands and Island Nations	Murrawah Maroochy Johnson	Australia	Blocked the development of the Waratah coal mine, which threatened the Bimblebox Nature Refuge and Indigenous rights, setting a precedent for linking climate change to human and Indigenous rights.

	North America	Andrea Vidaurre	United States	Advocated for and achieved the adoption of two historic transportation regulations in California, significantly limiting trucking and rail emissions to improve air quality and public health.
	South and Central America	Marcel Gomes	Brazil	Coordinated an international campaign linking beef from JBS, the world's largest meatpacking company, to illegal deforestation, leading major European retailers to halt JBS product sales.

Grammy Award

- The Grammy Award, often simply called a "Grammy," is one of the most prestigious honours in the music industry, awarded by the Recording Academy (formerly known as the National Academy of Recording Arts & Sciences, or NARAS) in the United States.
- The Grammy recognizes outstanding achievements in the music industry across a wide range of genres and categories.

Notable Indian Grammy Winners:

- **Ravi Shankar:** The legendary sitar virtuoso received five Grammy Awards, including a Lifetime Achievement Award, for his profound impact on world music.
- **Zakir Hussain:** Renowned tabla maestro, Zakir Hussain, has been honored with four Grammy Awards, recognizing his exceptional skill and contributions to global music.
- **A.R. Rahman:** The acclaimed composer won two Grammy Awards for his work on the "Slumdog Millionaire" soundtrack, including Best Compilation Soundtrack and Best Song Written for Visual Media.
- **Tanvi Shah:** As the first Indian woman to win a Grammy, Tanvi Shah was recognized for her contribution to the song "Jai Ho" from "Slumdog Millionaire."

Grammy Award Winners (2022–2024):

Year	Category	Winner	Work
2022	Best Global Music Album	Angelique Kidjo	"Mother Nature"
2022	Best Global Music Performance	Arooj Aftab	"Mohabbat"
2023	Best Global Music Album	Masa Takumi	"Sakura"
2023	Best Global Music Performance	Wouter Kellerman, Zakes Bantwini & Nomcebo Zikode	"Bayethe"
2024	Best Global Music Album	Shakti (featuring Shankar Mahadevan, Zakir Hussain, V. Selvaganesh, and Ganesh Rajagopalan)	"This Moment"
2024	Best Global Music Performance	Zakir Hussain, Bela Fleck, Edgar Meyer (featuring Rakesh Chaurasia)	"Pashto"

Highlights:

- **2024:** Indian fusion group **Shakti**, featuring Shankar Mahadevan and Zakir Hussain, won the Best Global Music Album for "This Moment." Additionally, Zakir Hussain, along with Bela Fleck and Edgar Meyer, featuring Rakesh Chaurasia, secured the Best Global Music Performance for "Pashto."